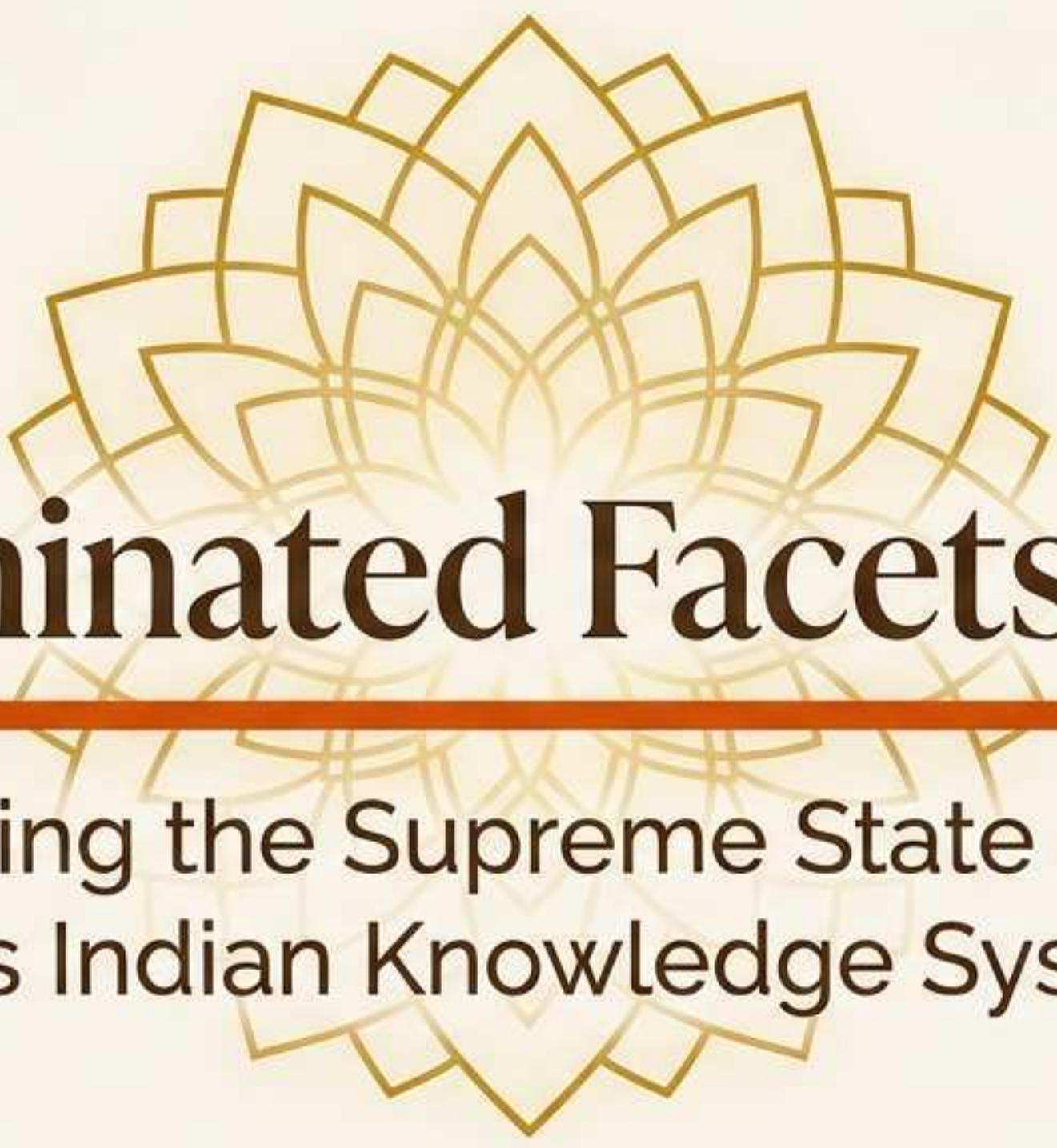




# The Illuminated Facets of Jnana

Demystifying the Supreme State of Ananda  
across Indian Knowledge Systems.

A VISUAL JOURNEY FROM ANCIENT UPANISHADIC  
METAPHORS TO MODERN, REPRODUCIBLE EXPERIENCES.



# The Paradox of the Inexpressible

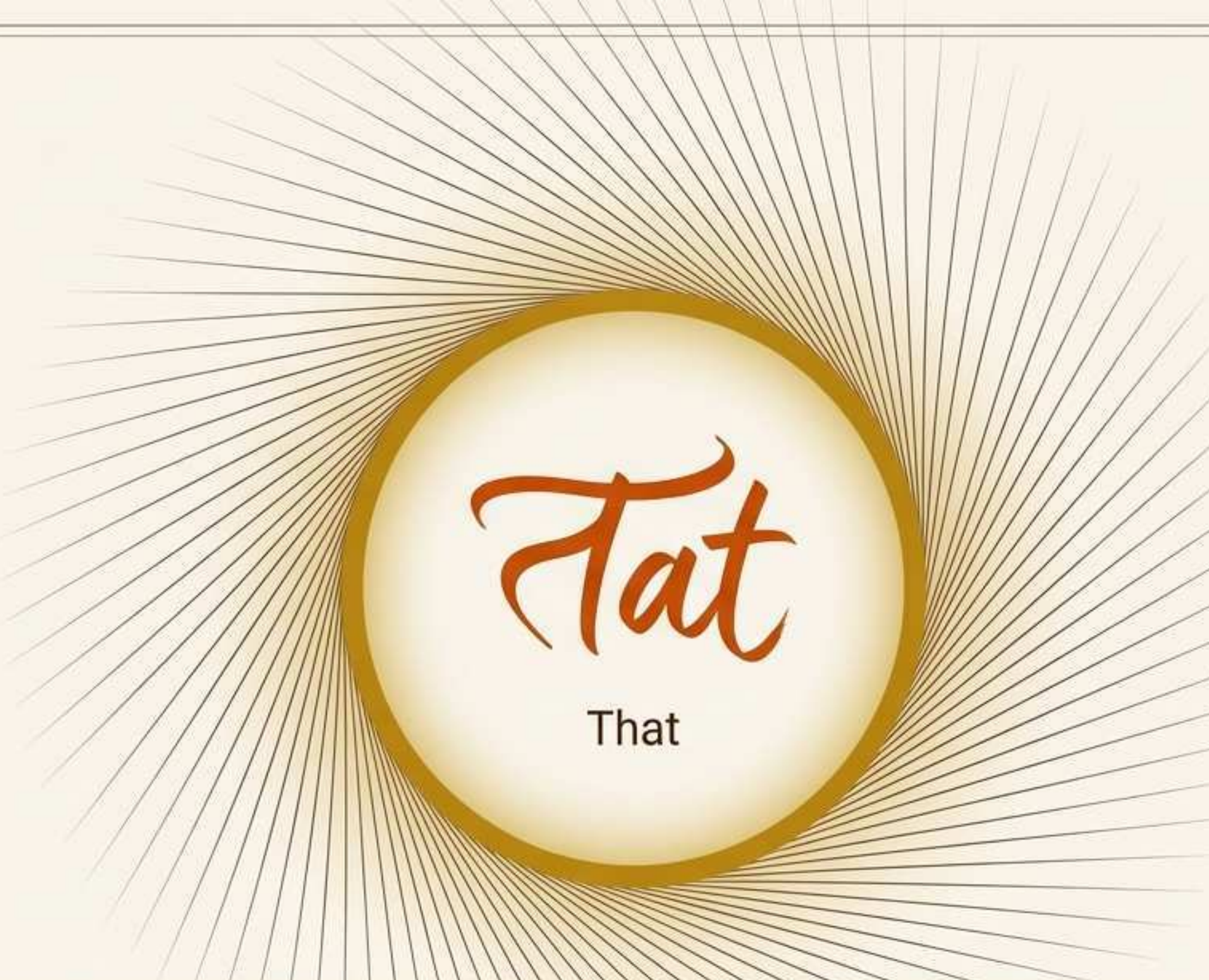
When the supreme state of Ananda (bliss) is attained, sages find themselves without words. The experience is so intense and absolute that human language fails. It is simply referred to as **Tat**—meaning That.

## Root Words of Inquiry

From root 'jñā' / 'vid' (to know):

|         |            |
|---------|------------|
| • Jnana | • Bodha    |
| • Veda  | • Prajnana |
| • Vidu  | • Vijnana  |

**Brahma Jijnasa** is the active inquiry into this ultimate nature. To understand it, we must look not at its name, but at the facets of the experience itself.

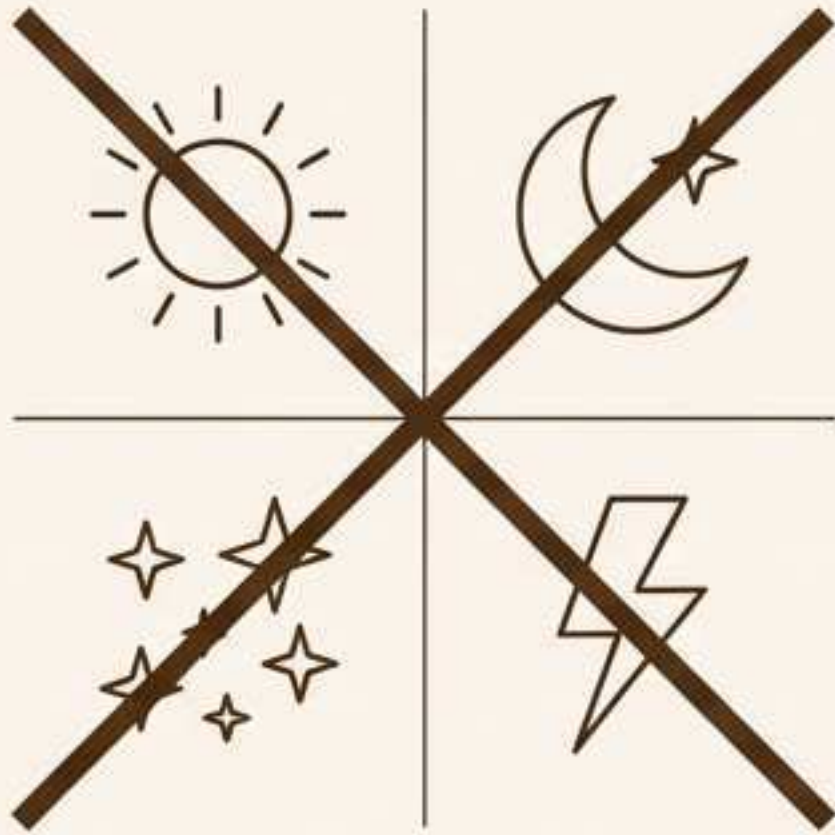


Tat

That



# The Metaphor of Absolute Luminosity



*Na tatra sūryo bhāti na candratāarakam... tasya  
bhāsā sarvam idaṃ vibhāti.*

KATHA UPANISHAD

There the sun does not shine, nor the moon and stars, lightning does not shine either — it alone shines, and because of it everything else shines. By its light all this world is illumined.



**Key Insight:** The most common ancient description relies on light—not as a physical source, but **as the foundational luminosity by which everything else is known.**



# The Experiential Paradox: Āpo Jyotiḥ Rasaḥ Amṛtam

The Taittiriya Aranyaka describes the supreme state through four simultaneous, contrasting qualities. How can intense brilliance be profoundly cooling?

**Āpaḥ** (Water-like)  
Extremely cool and  
calming.

**Rasaḥ** (Sweetness)  
Deep joy and  
experiential bliss.

Supreme  
Ananda

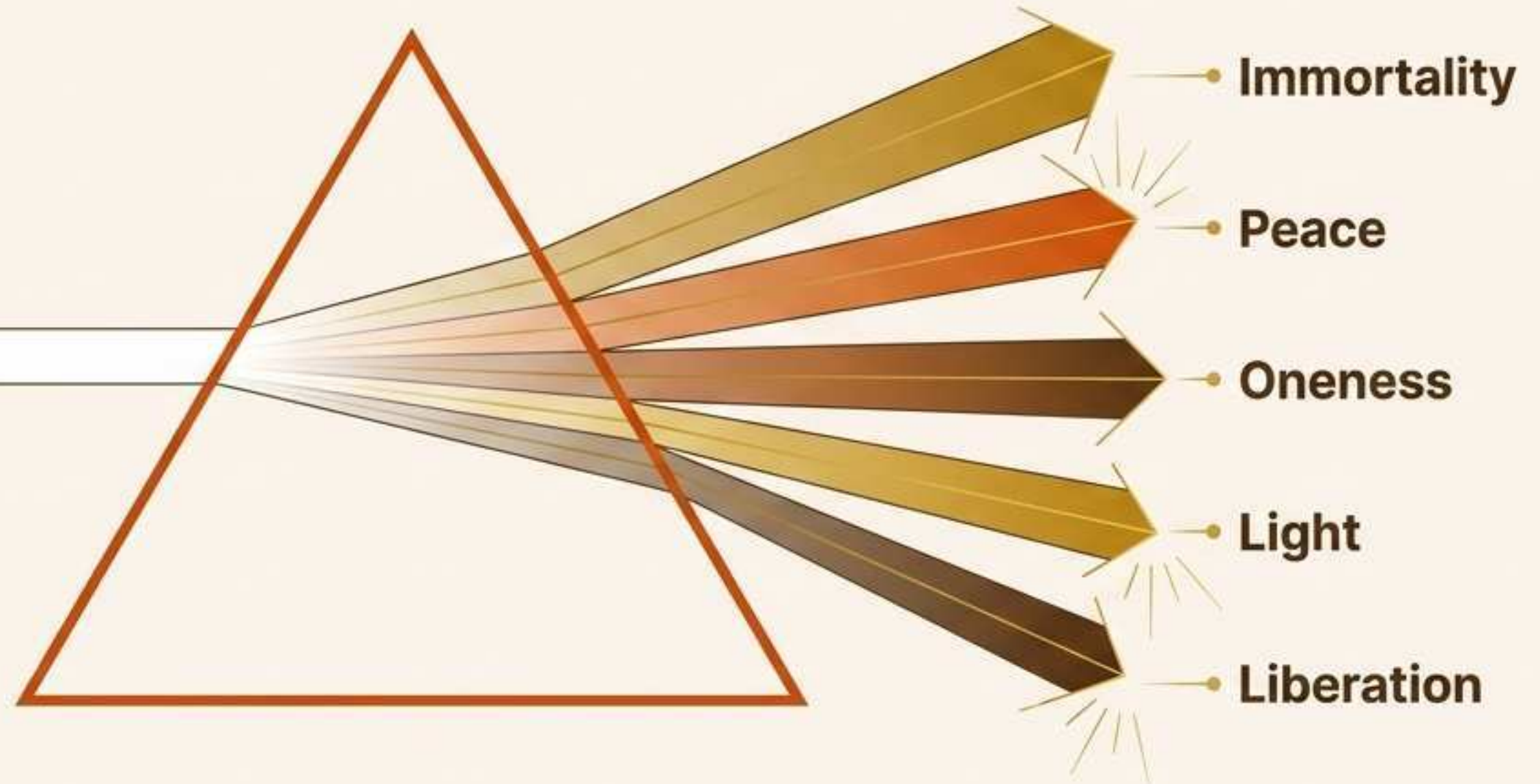
**Jyotiḥ** (Light)  
Intensely brilliant  
and luminous.

**Amṛtam** (Immortality)  
Absolute absence of the  
fear of death.



# One Experience, Refracted Through Language

The supreme state is singular, but human inquiry is multifaceted. Different traditions—Veda, Tantra, Yoga, and **Darshana**—have cataloged the exact same phenomenon using different terms, each illuminating a specific quality of the experience.





# The Anatomy of Jnana: The Yoga Shashtra Matrix

A compilation of synonyms drawn from Vedic, Tantric, Puranic, and Darshana texts by the **Hatha Yoga Pradipika**.

| The State of Union/Oneness | The State of Mind/Peace | The State of Purity/Void | The State of Liberation/Beyond | The State of Eternity |
|----------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------|
| Advaita                    | Samadhi                 | Śūnya                    | Jīvanmukti                     | Amaratva              |
|                            | Unmanī                  |                          |                                |                       |
| Laya-tattva                | Manonmanī               | Aśūnya                   | Turiya                         |                       |
|                            | Amanaskam               |                          |                                |                       |
| Rajayoga                   | Nirālambam              | Nirañjanam               | Paraṃpadam                     |                       |



# Dual Pillars of the Supreme State

## अक्षर

### Akṣara

#### CONCEPT: INDESTRUCTIBLE

That which cannot be destroyed or is ever-present. It represents the permanent, unshakeable foundation of the supreme state.

## सहज

### Sahaja

#### CONCEPT: THE NATURAL STATE

Supreme bliss is not an external object to be acquired or brought from outside. It is our original, baseline, natural condition.



# The Timeless Reproducibility of Discovery

The striking similarity in descriptions separated by thousands of years proves this is a reproducible, experiential science, not mere philosophy.

Ancient

19th/20th Century

## Taittiriya Aranyaka / Upanishads

### *The Standard*

Brilliant yet cooling...  
A central ocean of light.

## Ramakrishna Paramahansa

### *The Intimate Realization*

An experience even more  
intimate than the person  
asking the question can  
experience.

## Ramana Maharshi & Paul Brunton

### *The Sceptic's Witness*

The skeptic (Brunton) entered a  
trans-sensory state, describing  
it as being at the centre of an  
ocean of brilliant light.

**Srirang Mahaguru confirms: As brilliant as a crore suns or more,  
yet as cool and calming as moonbeams.**



# The Physical Mirror: Apo Jyotih in Daily Life

How do we conceptualize brilliant yet cooling? The traditional Aarti ritual provides a perfect physical manifestation of this spiritual paradox.

**Jyotiḥ**

Brilliance, Light,  
Golden hue.

**Āpaḥ**

Coolness,  
soothing  
reflection.

## The Synthesis

The eyes perceive intense golden light reflecting off the water, but the sensation is deeply soothing and cool—mirroring the exact description of the Upanishads.





# The Path of Inquiry (Brahma Jijnasa)

Supreme Jnana is not just to be read about; it is to be experienced.

1

## Experience the Paradox

In a quiet room, light a candle and watch its reflection in a bowl of water. Observe the presence of light alongside the coolness of the water. Sense the physical echo of Apo jyotiḥ.

2

## Contemplate the Facets

Reflect on the synonyms of the Yoga Shastras—Sahaja (natural), Advaita (oneness), Jivanmukti (liberated living). Ask yourself: which aspect of the supreme state does this word illuminate?

3

## Study the Witnesses

Seek out the accounts of Ramana Maharshi, Ramakrishna Paramahansa, or Srirang Mahaguru. Trace the parallels between their lived experiences and the ancient texts.